



Mass customization

Sophisticated technology and manufacturing developments allow mass products to be personalized. The low unit costs of mass production combine with the marketing opportunities of custom-made.

How it works

Mass customization offers new opportunities for the manufacturing and service industries. Social media, online technology, 3-D modeling tools, e-commerce software, and flexible production systems and processes are allowing customers to configure products to match their own tastes and needs. Industries such as footwear (particularly athletic shoes), clothing, cars, jewelry, and

computers already allow consumers to customize their purchases. The price is generally higher than for standardized goods.

Revolutionary new technologies are expected to further extend customization, allowing individuals to, for example, scan their body contours and use augmented reality to design and order unique clothing.

FOOD MIXES

The generation raised on social media expects to personalize every aspect of their lives, and food and drink is set to be a growth area for mass customization. Websites allow consumers to make their own cereal mixes, which is especially useful for those with allergies, and to create their own blends of tea and coffee.

Customers design own products

Mass customization has enormous potential to change consumerism. For example, consumers can buy shoes designed to their own specification via the internet. This is a high-status commodity among certain groups.



The customer decides

On the company's website, a drop-down menu, with options including style, shape, size, color, and laces, allows consumers to design their own pair of shoes.



Sends order to factory

The firm holds no finished stock but manufactures to order from a range of parts, getting paid by the customer before production.